MONTHLY REPORT

The Market *Signal*

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U.S. NATIONAL · WEST REGION · PHOENIX LENS

THE MONTH IN ONE READ

New supply is down from last year. Vacancy has not fallen yet.

RealPage counts 27% fewer U.S. completions through Q3 than a year earlier, yet Census rental vacancy rose to 7.6% in Q3 and Apartment List's index stood at 7.0% in October, below its 7.3% February peak. National asking rents were roughly flat. In the West, vacancy rose year over year and Phoenix's median rent is down 2.5% over 12 months, so national supply relief should not yet be read as local relief.

THE SIGNAL

27%	Fewer U.S. apartment completions, Jan to Sept 2026 vs. 2025 (Q3 rose from Q2)	RealPage Analytics, Oct 22, 2026
7.6%	U.S. rental vacancy rate, Q3 2026 (7.3% Q2 2026, 7.1% Q3 2025)	U.S. Census Bureau, Oct 28, 2026
6.7%	West region rental vacancy, Q3 2026 (6.0% a year earlier)	U.S. Census Bureau, Oct 28, 2026
7.0%	National vacancy index, October 2026 (7.3% February peak)	Apartment List, Oct 28, 2026
+0.1%	National median rent, 12 months to October ($1,384; down 0.3% in the month)	Apartment List, Oct 28, 2026

THE LOCAL REALITY

Phoenix was among the five metros RealPage named for the most Q3 2026 deliveries, each above 3,000 units.

Phoenix median rent: $1,250, down 2.5% over 12 months and 0.4% during October; Chandler had the metro's fastest annual growth (0.7%), Surprise the slowest (down 4.7%) (Apartment List).

Limitation: No verified Phoenix or Arizona vacancy or concession figure; Apartment List covers the city of Phoenix, not the metro. No verified Seattle figure.

THE OPERATOR DECISION

Is your vacancy coming from fewer renters finding you, or from more choices near you?

Which floor plans carry the most days vacant, and do they have their own photos and pricing online?

Do 2027 budgets assume vacancy improves on the national supply timeline or the local one?

THE WATCH LIST

INDICATOR	EXPECTED	DATE STATUS	OWNER
Apartment List national vacancy, November data	Late Nov 2026	Estimated	LocalLift research desk
RealPage Q4 supply update, Phoenix volume	Late Jan 2027	Estimated	LocalLift research desk
Census rental vacancy, Q4 2026 (national and West)	Early Feb 2027	Estimated	LocalLift research desk

METHODOLOGY

Figures come from each publisher's own public release and are checked against it before publication. Census vacancy covers all rental housing and carries sampling error; rent measures differ by source, so figures are compared within a source. Local Reality, Operator Decision and interpretation lines are ours, logged in the Signal Ledger with a confidence level. NMHC's October survey is held until its figures can be read on NMHC's own page.

SOURCES

RealPage Analytics, U.S. Apartment Supply Update 3rd Quarter 2026, Oct 22, 2026
U.S. Census Bureau, Quarterly Residential Vacancies and Homeownership, Third Quarter 2026, Oct 28, 2026
Apartment List, National Rent Report, Headline Market Update: November 2026, Oct 28, 2026
Apartment List, Phoenix Rent Report, November 2026